

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 225 · HOT

Hightouch

Marketing Technology · Customer Data Platform / AI Decisioning · San Francisco · Private (\$2.75B; \$150M Series D, Apr 2026)

San Francisco marketing-data company Hightouch announced a \$150M Series D at a \$2.75B valuation on 29 April 2026, led by Goldman Sachs Alternatives' growth arm and Bain Capital Ventures, more than doubling its price in fourteen months. Its buyers are chief marketing officers, the audience paddock hospitality was built for.

73

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

McLaren
Mastercard F1
Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Hightouch announced on 29 April that it had raised \$150M in a Series D led by Growth Equity at Goldman Sachs Alternatives and Bain Capital Ventures at a \$2.75B valuation, with Iconiq, Sapphire Ventures, Amplify, Y Combinator and TD7, The Trade Desk's venture arm, participating; total funding is about \$322M. Hightouch says revenue has grown more than 100% in each of the past two years, and names Domino's, PetSmart, DraftKings, Ramp and Whoop among customers. Its Series C, \$80M at \$1.2B led by Sapphire, closed in February 2025.

The product is a marketing data layer that reads a company's warehouse and pushes audiences to advertising, email and CRM tools, with AI agents deciding what each customer sees next. It is bought by marketing leaders, which makes the paddock a sales floor, not a billboard. Gartner named Hightouch a Leader in its 2025 Magic Quadrant for customer data platforms in January, and no team on the grid carries a partner in the category.

WHY NOW

The round was announced on 29 April; budgets reset in the quarter after a raise, and Hightouch is spending on category leadership. The European rounds from Monaco, then the US GP and Las Vegas, fall inside the window, and teams close 2027 rosters in the fourth quarter.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$150M

\$150M Series D at a \$2.75B valuation led by Growth Equity at Goldman Sachs Alternatives and Bain Capital Ve...

\$80M

Goldman Sachs Alternatives (Growth Equity), Bain Capital Ventures, Iconiq, Sapphire Ventures, Amplify Partn...

\$322M

total funding is about \$322M.

100%

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GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Oracle Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Scuderia Ferrari HP	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A \$150M Series D at \$2.75B, revenue more than doubling for two years and a customer list that includes Whoop and DraftKings put Hightouch at peak brand-investment authority. McLaren's fan-data lane opened when Salesforce departed, and the buyers Hightouch needs are already in the paddock.

WHY MCLAREN MASTERCARD F1 TEAM

McLaren carries the longest technology roster in the sponsor table, and its fan-data lane has just opened: Salesforce, whose platform ran McLaren's fan-relationship programme, has departed, while Google Cloud has joined. Alteryx and Splunk cover analytics and observability; nothing on the roster activates fan data into media, email and the store. Hightouch fills that slot, with a warehouse-side partner already in place.

VALUE TO MCLAREN MASTERCARD F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. Hightouch as the activation layer on McLaren's fan data: audiences built from ticketing, store, app and content behaviour in the team's warehouse, pushed to paid media, email and the McLaren store, with AI decisioning choosing the next offer for each fan. The team gets a measured lift in fan revenue; Hightouch gets a reference customer and a paddock full of chief marketing officers at the US GP and Las Vegas.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Marketing Data Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, covering the next raise and a probable listing window. Estimated \$2-4M a year, part in kind via platform licence and services. Scope: mirror or engine-cover placement, a fan-data activation programme with McLaren's digital team, CMO hospitality at the US rounds, and a co-authored annual fan-data report.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Kashish Gupta

CO-FOUNDER & CO-CEO, HIGHTOUCH · VERIFIED

Gupta co-founded Hightouch in 2018 and shares the CEO role with Tejas Manohar; a Wharton graduate and former Bessemer investor, he fronts the raises. Path: Tejas Manohar, Co-Founder & Co-CEO; Cherry Miao, CFO; Brian Kotlyar, VP Marketing & Growth. No chief marketing officer is listed.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the buyer, not the badge.

"Kashish, your buyers are CMOs, and every one of them passes through a Formula 1 paddock. McLaren's fan-data lane opened when Salesforce left, and Google Cloud just arrived. 25 minutes before Monaco to see the numbers?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING

17 / 20

Round announced 29 Apr; European rounds and two US races ahead.

CAPACITY

15 / 20

\$2.75B valuation; \$322M raised; a mid-tier partner budget.

BRAND FIT

13 / 20

B2B martech; the paddock is where its buyers are.

URGENCY

12 / 20

No listing date; category leadership is the only clock.

OPS FIT

16 / 20

MODE A: fan-data activation on a warehouse the team runs.

RISKS & COUNTERS

ADJACENT ROSTER Freshworks and Medallia sit on McLaren's roster in customer software; a marketing-data partner must be scoped so neither reads it as a rival. **Counter:** Define the category as warehouse-native fan-data activation; get written non-conflict from McLaren before signing.

SCALE FOR THE ROSTER At \$2.75B and \$322M raised, Hightouch is a mid-tier partner on the grid's longest technology roster; car visibility will be modest. **Counter:** Buy the workstream and the hospitality, not the livery; measure the deal on pipeline from the paddock.

SOURCES — 15 OF 15 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- <https://craft.co/hightouch/executives>
- [https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260427054567/en/Hightouch-Raises-\\$150-Million-to-Reinvent-How-Marketing-Works-Using-AI](https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260427054567/en/Hightouch-Raises-$150-Million-to-Reinvent-How-Marketing-Works-Using-AI)
- <https://www.adweek.com/dealroom/hightouch-raised-322-million-across-six-rounds-heres-how-the-company-skyrocketed-to-a-275-billion-valuation/>